

THE BLOCKBLASTERS BREACH

ANATOMY OF A GAMING CRYPTOSTEALER

ISSESSIONS

- FALL 2025 -

1st SESSION

CYBERSECURITY

ANALYSIS - JON MARIEN



SECURITY BREACH

THE HUMAN COST

This is the story of **Raivo "RastalandTV" Plavnieks**, a 26-year-old Latvian streamer battling stage 4 sarcoma cancer.

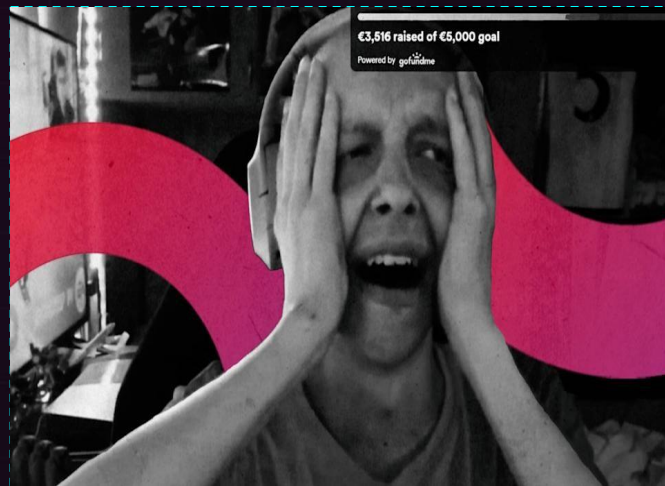
He created a Solana-based token called **"Help Me Beat Cancer" (CANCER)** on Pump.fun to raise funds for his treatment.

\$31,189 for cancer treatment...

...stolen in an instant.

"I can't breathe, I can't think, I'm completely lost on what is going to happen next. Can't shake the feeling that it is my fault[...] I might end up on the street again or not have anything to eat in [a] few days. My heart wants to jump out of my mouth, and it hurts. "

Plavnieks, on X.



MISSION BRIEFING



The BlockBlasters Incident: A Case Study



Platform Responsibility: The Valve Vector



Technical Deep Dive: Inside StealC Malware



Detection & Response



Lessons Learned



The Rogues' Gallery: StealC vs. Others



Protecting Yourself: Actionable Recommendations

THE DECEPTION: A PERFECT TROJAN HORSE

BlockBlasters appeared to be a legitimate 2D platformer/shooter game developed by "Genesis Interactive" and released on Steam on July 31, 2025.

July 31, 2025

Initial release - completely clean game

For One Month

Built positive reputation, accumulated favorable reviews

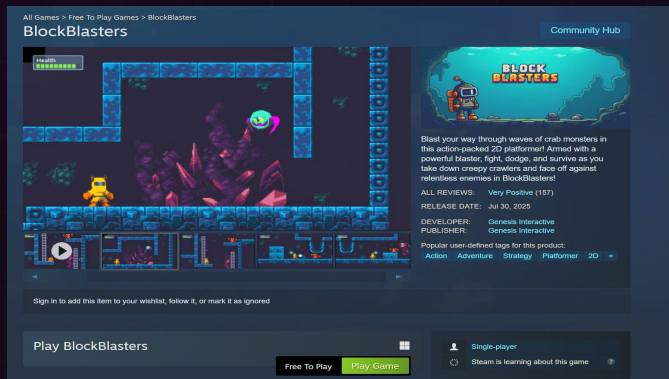
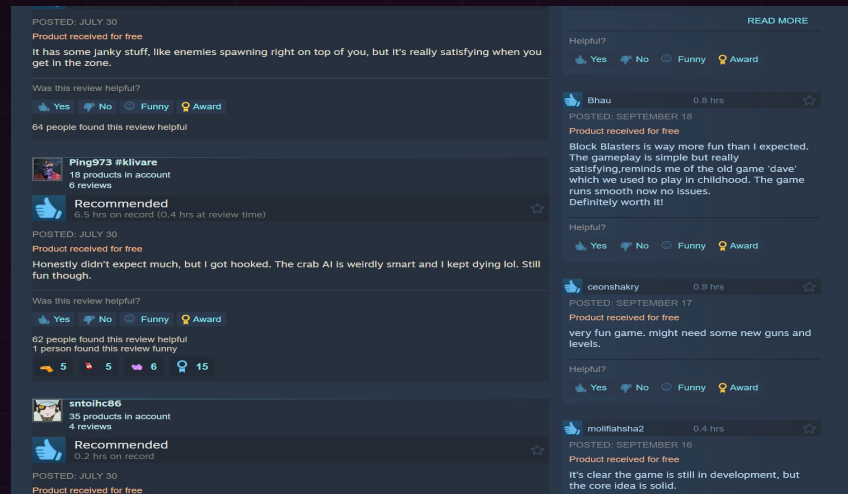
August 30, 2025

Malicious update (**Build 19799326**) deployed



Classic Trojan Horse Strategy:

Build trust first, attack later



THE BETRAYAL AND MOCKERY

July 31, 2025

Game released on Steam - completely clean game files

August 30, 2025

Build 19799326 - Malicious update containing StealC cryptostealer

September 21, 2025

"Final" wind: Game replaced with a single file named "**hi.txt**" before removal

Build 19799326 on 30 August 2025

30 August 2025 → Build 19799326 Edited 25 days ago by Wendy

Share

There are no official patch notes available for this build besides the list of changed files in 1 depot.

CHANGED FILES IN THIS UPDATE

3

Depot 3872351

- Modified Engine/Binaries/ThirdParty/Ogg/game2.bat (+10 B)
- Modified Engine/Binaries/ThirdParty/Ogg/v1.zip
- Modified Engine/Binaries/ThirdParty/Ogg/v3.zip (+5 B)
- Manifest ID changed - **2743204767822927231** > **973025817327683970**

CHANGED FILES IN THIS UPDATE

+1 -832

Depot 3872351

- Added **hi.txt** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/1.sga**
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/VariantManagerContent.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/TraceUtilities.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/ToolPresets.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Synthesis.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/StructUtils.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Scalability.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/RuntimeOptions.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Paper2D.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Paper2D.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Niagara.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Metasound.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Interchange.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/InstallBundle.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/Input.ini** (2 B)
- Removed **MegaActionPlatformer/Saved/Config/Windows/iKrig.ini** (2 B)

THE IMPACT & RESPONSE

The **BlockBlasters** cryptostealer had a devastating impact across hundreds of victims.

\$150,000+

Total funds stolen

~400

Estimated victims

\$31,189

RastalandTV's loss

30

Days on Steam

Types of Data Compromised (%)



Crypto Wallets Steam Accounts Browser Data Other

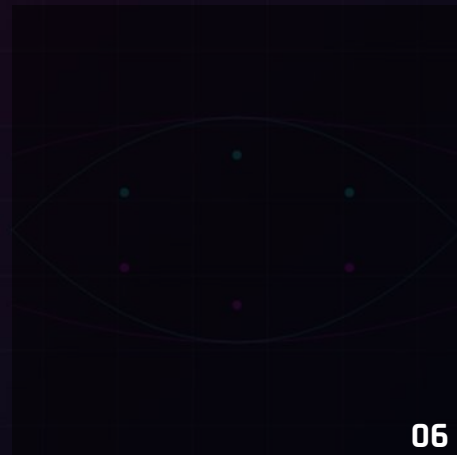
Community Response



Alex Becker donated \$32,500 to cover losses



CANCER token surged **3,000%** to \$2.5M market cap



PLATFORM RESPONSIBILITY: THE VALVE VECTOR

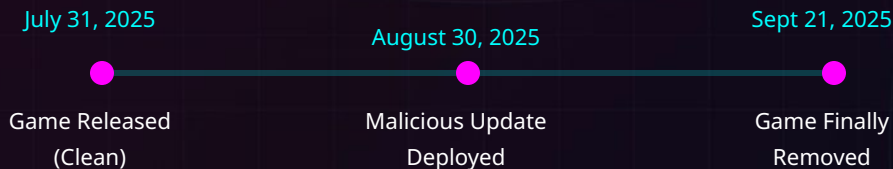
A Colossal Failure

The malware was active on Steam for **nearly a month** before being removed.

How can one of the world's **largest gaming platforms** fail to detect malicious code in a game update?



Timeline of Failure



The Security Gap

While initial game submissions undergo scrutiny, **updates receive minimal vetting** - creating a perfect attack vector.

A PATTERN OF ABUSE

BlockBlasters is not an isolated incident. Throughout 2025, multiple games on Steam have been used to distribute malware, showing a clear pattern of abuse.



PirateFi

A pirate-themed crypto game that contained a similar cryptostealer variant.



Chemia

A chemistry puzzle game that deployed malware through a post-release update.



Sniper: Phantom's Resolution

A shooter that initially passed verification but later distributed malware.

The Critical Question:

Why is Valve's vetting process failing to detect malicious updates to previously approved games?

TECHNICAL DEEP DIVE: INSIDE STEALC

StealC is a sophisticated **Malware-as-a-Service (MaaS)**

information stealer that first appeared in early 2023.

Key Characteristics:

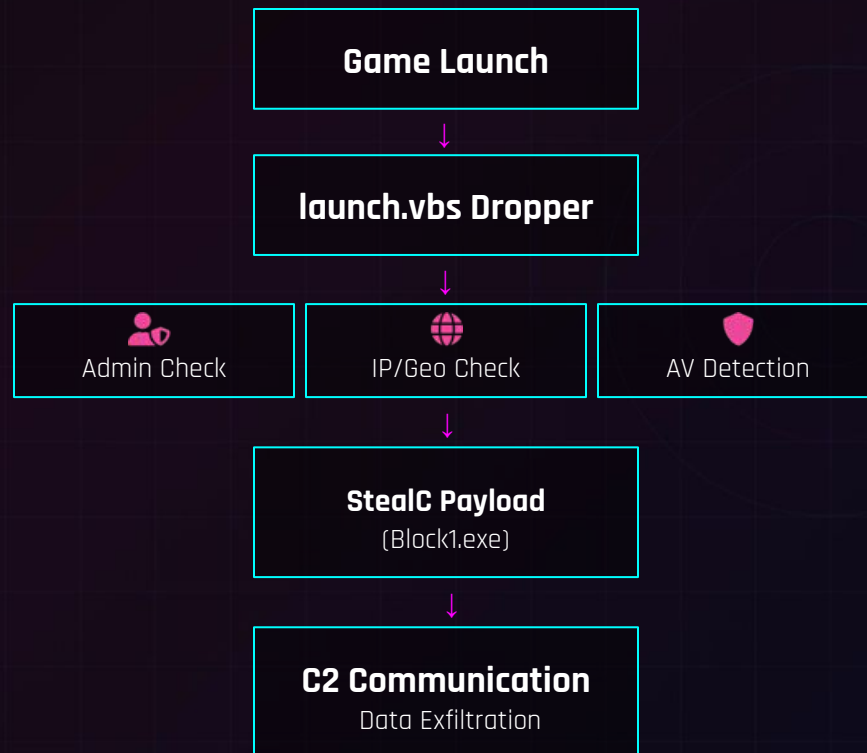
Sold on Russian-speaking underground forums

Written in C++

Uses Themida packing for obfuscation

Targets browsers, crypto wallets, and gaming credentials

The **BlockBlasters** variant was specifically configured to target Steam users and cryptocurrency holders.



THEFT, EXFILTRATION, AND TARGETING

Primary Targets

-  **Steam Credentials** from loginusers.vdf
-  **Browser Data** (cookies, passwords, autofill)
-  **Crypto Wallets** (Phantom, Solflare, others)

Exfiltration Process



Code Snippet: Steam Credential Theft

Parses `loginusers.vdf` line-by-line looking for:

- "AccountName"
- "PersonaName"
- "RememberPassword"

Writes entries to `%TEMP%\us_report.txt`

```
:: --- OPTIONAL FRIENDLY NAMES (leave empty to show ID) ---
set "name.bfnaelbmomeimhlpmgjnjoiphpkoljpa-Phantom"
set "name.nkbihfboegaaoehlefknodbefgpgknn-MetaMask"
set "name.ejbalbakoplchlghcedalmeeeajnimhm-MetaMask Edge"
set "name.mkepgjkbklkefacfnmkajcjmabijhclg-Magic Eden"
set "name.bhhhlbepdkbapadjdnojkbgioioibic-Solflare"
set "name.ibnejdfjmknpcnlpebklnmkoeioihofec-TronLink"
set "name.jiidiaalimhddjgbnbgdffeolocpak-Bitget Wallet"
set "name.egjidjbgplchdcondcbdnbeppgdph-Trust Wallet"
set "name.hnfanfnocfeofbdddgcijnhfnfnkndnaad-Coinbase Wallet"
```

```
:: --- SUMMARY ACCUMULATOR (file-based, for reliable newlines) ---
set "FOUND_FILE=%TEMP%\ext_found_list.txt"
if exist "%FOUND_FILE%" del "%FOUND_FILE%" >nul 2>&1
set "FOUND_ANY="
```

```
echo.
echo ==== Scanning installed extensions ====
echo.

call :scan_les "Chrome" "%LOCALAPPDATA%\Google\Chrome\User Data"
call :scan_les "Edge" "%LOCALAPPDATA%\Microsoft\Edge\User Data"
call :scan_les "Brave" "%LOCALAPPDATA%\BraveSoftware\Brave-Browser\User Data"
call :scan_les "Vivaldi" "%LOCALAPPDATA%\Vivaldi\User Data"
call :scan_les2 "Opera Stable" "%APPDATA%\Opera Software\Opera Stable"
call :scan_les2 "Opera GX2" "%APPDATA%\Opera Software\Opera GX Stable"
```

Targeted Attack Strategy

The C2 server maintained a `whitelisted_users.txt` file containing high-value targets who would receive special, more aggressive payloads.

```
if playerfound==1 or
auto==1:
    # Deploy special payload
    extract v1.zip to DEST_DIR
    run launch1.vbs
else:
    # Deploy standard payload
    extract v2.zip to
DEST_DIR1
    run Block1.exe
```

DETECTION & RESPONSE

Key Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

File Hashes:

Block1.exe: 8f4b2e7d9c...

C2 Server:

IP: 203.188.171.156

Registry:

HKCU\...\Run\ BlockBlasters

Files:

%TEMP%\ us_report.txt

Detection Methods

Network Monitoring

Watch for suspicious HTTP POST requests

File System Monitoring

Detect unexpected VBS scripts

Response Actions:

Isolate infected systems

Reset all credentials stored in browsers

Check crypto wallets for unauthorized transactions

Scan for persistence mechanisms

YARA Rule Example

```
rule StealC_BlockBlasters {
  meta:
    description = "Detects StealC variant"
    author = "VX-Underground"

  strings:
    $s1 = "loginusers.vdf" ascii wide
    $s2 = "us_report.txt" ascii wide
    $s3 = "BlockBlasters" ascii wide

    $hex1 = { 8B 45 FC 89 45 F4 8B 45 F4 }

  condition:
    uint16(0) == 0x5A4D and
    filesize < 5MB and
    (all of ($s*) or $hex1)
}
```

LESSONS LEARNED



For Security Community

Supply chain attacks are evolving beyond traditional software repositories

Gaming platforms are now prime targets for malware distribution

Continuous monitoring of game updates is now essential



For Attackers

OPSEC failures: Exposed Telegram bot tokens

Vulnerable C2 server allowed researchers to gain access

Lack of proper encryption for stolen data



For Platforms

Updates need the same scrutiny as initial submissions

Automated scanning for known malware signatures is insufficient

Need for behavioral analysis of game executables

The Bigger Picture:

The BlockBlasters incident demonstrates how **trust is weaponized** in modern supply chain attacks. By establishing legitimacy first and deploying malware later, attackers exploit the reduced scrutiny given to updates from "trusted" developers.

THE ROGUES' GALLERY: STEALC VS. OTHERS

Feature	StealC	Vidar	Raccoon	RedLine
Distribution	MaaS, 2023	MaaS, 2018	MaaS, 2019	MaaS, 2020
Origin	Games, malvertising	Malvertising, phishing	Phishing, Telegram	Phishing, Discord
Language	C++	C++	C++	.NET
Obfuscation	Themida	Custom	Custom	ConfuserEx
C2 Protocol	HTTP	HTTP	HTTP	HTTP
Unique Feature	RC4 encryption	Screenshot capability	Crypto extension focus	VPN credential theft

While StealC shares many characteristics with other info-stealers, its **distribution through gaming platforms** and **RC4 encryption** in newer versions set it apart. It represents an evolution of the MaaS model, with developers actively responding to detection methods.



PROTECTING YOURSELF: FOR GAMERS



Be Wary of Updates

Check for unusual update patterns or sizes. Be especially cautious of games that suddenly update after long periods of inactivity.



Use Reputable Antivirus

Ensure your antivirus is updated and includes gaming mode to minimize performance impact while maintaining protection.



Use Standard User Accounts

Never run games with administrator privileges. This limits what malware can access and install on your system.



Avoid Pirated Games

Pirated games are common malware vectors. Stick to official stores and verified developers.



Separate Gaming Environment

Consider using a dedicated machine or virtual environment for gaming, separate from sensitive activities.



Research Before Installing

Check developer history, reviews, and community feedback before installing new games, especially from unknown studios.



Remember:

Even legitimate-looking games from trusted platforms can be compromised. Trust, but verify.

PROTECTING YOURSELF: FOR CRYPTO USERS



Use Hardware Wallets

Keep your private keys offline with hardware wallets like Ledger or Trezor. Never store significant amounts in hot wallets.



Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

Use hardware keys or authenticator apps, not SMS-based 2FA, for all exchange accounts and wallets that support it.



Use a Dedicated Device

Consider using a separate device exclusively for crypto transactions, isolated from gaming and general browsing.



HARDWARE WALLET

The most secure option for crypto storage



Be Wary of Phishing Attacks

Double-check URLs, never click suspicious links, and be skeptical of unsolicited messages about crypto opportunities.



Do Your Own Research (DYOR)

Verify projects before investing. Be wary of unrealistic returns or high-pressure tactics.

CONCLUSION & Q&A

Key Takeaways



Gaming platforms are now prime targets for sophisticated supply chain attacks.



Trust is weaponized through the Trojan Horse strategy: build legitimacy first, attack later.



A security-conscious mindset is your best defense in an increasingly hostile digital landscape.

Questions?

Thank you for attending this ISSessions presentation on the BlockBlasters cryptostealer incident.



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chronoblaze

The most dangerous threats are the ones that appear legitimate.

Q&A